

COINPICKS · RESEARCH &amp; EDUCATION

# The CLARITY Act Pillar Report

## The Crypto Rules Bill — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written **June 5, 2026**; scores committed by me on **June 12, 2026**. Fully re-researched **July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026**, and again as full weekly refreshes on **August 8 and August 22, 2026**. Drafts were written **August 17, 18, and 20** but none was delivered, and an **August 21** session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports before stopping, also not delivered. A same-day **2026-08-22\_draft** catch-up cycle independently re-verified the hold and was fully delivered — rendered, selfchecked, archived, and git-committed — but stayed uncommitted after a fact-check that cycle caught a materially false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report; the same-day full weekly refresh that followed, **2026-08-22\_draft2**, independently re-confirmed the hold again and was **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** — the last committed baseline: 32/47/58/82/92. A subsequent **2026-08-28\_draft** daily catch-up cycle was researched (held flat, logged a Polymarket drift to 14%) but was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed — treated as not delivered, superseded by this cycle. **This version — 2026-08-29\_draft, a FULL WEEKLY refresh, the first deep multi-source research dive since Aug 22 — independently re-verifies everything again via a dedicated primary-source research pass, and HOLDS FLAT at 32/47/58/82/92**, unchanged since Aug 8. The Sept 15 cloture-on-motion-to-proceed date remains the only scheduled floor action, reconfirmed by DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) and Motley Fool/CryptoSlate/CryptoRank (Aug 22), with no schedule change found Aug 22-29; both binding disputes (ethics/conflict-of-interest and stablecoin yield) remain fully unresolved; CFTC Chair Michael Selig, in an on-record Aug 20, 2026 speech (verified directly against cftc.gov), directed CFTC staff to explore a fallback crypto-market-structure rulemaking if CLARITY continues to stall — the CFTC's analog to SEC Chair Atkins' earlier unilateral-authority statement, logged as context, not used to move P; DeFiRate.com's Aug 27 pull shows Polymarket 13-14% and Kalshi 20-21%, both market prices, not institutional estimates, and insufficient alone to move P; and a "Sen. Tim Scott: 12-18 Democrats open" quote was traced to an **August 2025** story (a year old) and flagged as a likely search-artifact, explicitly NOT used. **No window moved and no call band flipped for CLARITY — this cycle is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of how small (here, zero) the moves are, so 2026-08-29\_draft is LEFT**

~~11 DRAFT, NOT auto-stamped, AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW~~ — see My

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

Decision below.

June column committed by me June 12, 2026. Aug 16 is the prior auto-stamped daily baseline. Per house rule, drafts only collapse out of this table once a set actually commits — Aug 22 draft2 committed Aug 23 and stays visible below since it's the last committed set; the new Aug 29 column has not committed, nothing collapsed from here, but Jul 17, 18, and 20 drafts were written but never delivered; an Aug 21 session delivered the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports before stopping, also not delivered. The same-day Aug 22 catch-up draft (d1) held flat, was fully delivered, rendered, selfchecked, archived, committed to git, but stayed uncommitted after an adversarial fact-check caught independently re-verified, held flat. Last committed by Alex August 23, 2026 (2026-08-23\_draft2 (d2)), still the stamped baseline. ~~2026-08-29\_draft1 (d1)~~, independently re-confirmed the hold and was ~~COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026~~ — the last committed baseline. A subsequent **2026-08-28 draft** daily catch-up cycle was researched (held flat) but never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed — treated as not delivered, dropped from this visible lineage (see What Changed for the audit note). This cycle's **2026-08-29\_draft**, a FULL WEEKLY refresh, independently re-confirms the hold again via fresh primary-source research and is left as draft, AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW.

| WINDOW   | JUN | ... | 8/16 | 8/22 D2<br>(COMMITTED) | 8/29 | QUAL. | IMP. | SIGNAL | MY CALL                                                                          |
|----------|-----|-----|------|------------------------|------|-------|------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 month  | 55  | ... | 32   | 32                     | 32   | 0.85  | 8    | -2.45  | Bear — cloture vote itself falls outside this 30-day window                      |
| 3 months | 60  | ... | 47   | 47                     | 47   | 0.85  | 8    | -0.41  | Mild Bear — a dated Sept 15 procedural vote now sits squarely inside this window |
| 6 months | 65  | ... | 58   | 58                     | 58   | 0.85  | 8    | +1.09  | Mild Bull                                                                        |
| 1 year   | 85  | ... | 82   | 82                     | 82   | 0.90  | 8    | +4.61  | Strong Bull                                                                      |
| 3 years  | 92  | ... | 92   | 92                     | 92   | 0.95  | 8    | +6.38  | Very Strong Bull                                                                 |

**Draft P (2026-08-29\_draft, awaiting review; last committed set remains Aug 22 d2, stamped by Alex Aug 23):** 32 / 47 / 58 / 82 / 92 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P - 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 55/60/65/85/92 (Jun 12) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8-Aug 7 path) → Aug 8 32/47/58/82/92 (3mo up — Thune files cloture, locking in a Sept 15-16 procedural vote; committed and stamped by Alex) → Aug 9-16 32/47/58/82/92 (held flat, auto-stamped daily; Aug 16 committed) → Aug 17 draft (written, never delivered) → Aug 18 draft (written, never delivered) → Aug 20 draft (written, never delivered) → Aug 21 session (delivered the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports, never finished/rendered/archived/committed) → Aug 22 draft d1 32/47/58/82/92 (held flat, independently re-verified, catch-up cycle — fully delivered: rendered, selfchecked, archived, git-committed — but left uncommitted after an Iran War Risk fact-check issue held the whole set) → Aug 22 draft d2 32/47/58/82/92 (held flat again, full weekly refresh, independently re-confirmed via fresh primary-source research) — **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026**, the last committed baseline → Aug 28 draft (daily catch-up, held flat, logged a Polymarket drift to 14%, but never rendered/selfchecked/archived/committed — treated as not delivered, superseded) → **Aug 29 draft 32/47/58/82/92** (held flat again, full weekly refresh, independently re-confirmed via fresh primary-source research including new CFTC Chair Selig context) — left as draft at delivery, because full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

**P** — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Held flat this cycle at 32/47/58/82/92 — unchanged since Aug 8, through the committed Aug 22 refresh (d2), the abandoned/never-delivered Aug 28 daily draft, and now this full weekly refresh (2026-08-29\_draft), all independently re-verified against fresh primary sources rather than trusted at face value. The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture vote on the motion to proceed remains the only scheduled floor date, reconfirmed this cycle by DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) and by Motley Fool/CryptoSlate/CryptoRank (Aug 22), with no schedule change found anywhere Aug 22-29 — and it bears repeating this is a cloture vote on the motion to proceed only, not final passage, which still needs its own floor debate/amendments and its own 60 votes. Both binding disputes remain fully unresolved as of today: the ethics/conflict-of-interest provision (Tillis-Gallego bipartisan counter-proposal — no White House sign-off or

released text found this cycle) and the stablecoin-yield dispute (no update found). NEW, CONFIRMED this cycle: CFTC Chair Michael Selig, in an on-record speech at the Innovation Advisory Committee's inaugural meeting, directed CFTC staff to explore a fallback crypto-market-structure rulemaking using the CFTC's existing authorities in case CLARITY continues to stall — adversarially verified directly against [cftc.gov](#) (PressRoom/SpeechesTestimony/opaselig10), dated **August 20, 2026** (some secondary outlets, e.g. American Banker/PYMNTS/The Hill, dated it Aug 21, likely next-day pickup; [cftc.gov](#) used as the primary date). Direct quote: "If CLARITY continues to stall because of Democratic obstruction, the CFTC will utilize its existing authorities to begin establishing a regime for crypto asset markets." This is the CFTC's analog to SEC Chair Atkins' already-logged Jul 29 unilateral-authority statement — it does not touch either binding dispute and is logged as context, not used to move P, same treatment as the SEC's earlier fallback signal. Two independent prediction-market pulls this cycle show a consistent low-teens-to-20s read: DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) cites Polymarket 13-14% ("signed in 2026") and Kalshi 20-21% ("60 votes" by Jan 1 2027); a live Aug 28 Polymarket pull separately showed 14% — both labeled as market prices, not institutional estimates, and per house rule cannot move P without a corroborating news event, none found. A "Sen. Tim Scott: 12-18 Democrats open to voting for CLARITY" quote surfaced in this cycle's search and was cross-checked to an **August 19, 2025** (one year earlier) CoinDesk/Politico Pro story from a prior year's SALT Wyoming/Jackson Hole symposium — flagged as a likely search-engine year-confusion artifact and explicitly NOT used as evidence of an Aug 2026 development. [congress.gov](#) and [dailypress.senate.gov](#) both returned HTTP 403 to direct fetch attempts this cycle (bot-blocking); primary-source confirmation relied on 7+ independent secondary outlets instead, consistent with how prior cycles have had to handle this. Context only, not new: the Senate passed a stopgap funding bill Aug 8 (Collins-Murray deal) funding the government through Dec 11, 2026 — modestly reduces (doesn't eliminate) the risk of a shutdown fight eating September floor time around Sept 15. The move stays flat because Republicans still hold only 53 of the 60 votes needed and roughly zero Democrats are confirmed as yes votes. The actual live blocker, unchanged since Aug 8: a *toughened* Democratic ethics counter-proposal has sat unanswered at the White House since roughly Aug 1-3. Long-term still high — even the bears argue "slips past the midterms," not "dies."

**Quality** — how trustworthy the evidence is. Unchanged this cycle per house rules.

**Impact** — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. This bill writes the rules for the entire market.

## The Claim

*The thesis as of August 29, 2026 (full weekly refresh, 2026-08-29\_draft), and where I differ from the consensus — flat since Aug 8, through the committed Aug 22 refresh, an abandoned/never-delivered Aug 28 daily draft, and now this week's full independent re-dig, nothing structural moved*

**The crowd:** is watching CFTC Chair Michael Selig's Aug 20 warning that the CFTC will move on its own "if CLARITY continues to stall because of Democratic obstruction" — a second regulator (after SEC Chair Atkins in July) publicly floating a legislative bypass. Prediction markets read this as more downside than upside: DeFiRate.com's Aug 27 pull puts Polymarket at 13-14% and Kalshi at 20-21%, both near cycle lows. A stray "12-18 Democrats open" quote also circulated this week, but it traces to an August 2025 story, not anything new.

**Me:** holding at 32/47/58/82/92 unchanged since Aug 8 — including through the committed Aug 22 full weekly refresh, an Aug 28 daily catch-up draft that was researched but never delivered (superseded, not treated as evidence), and today's separate full weekly refresh, independently re-verifying all of it again against fresh primary sources. The Sept 15 cloture date is reconfirmed with no schedule change; both binding disputes — the unanswered ethics counter-proposal and the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute — remain open as of today, with no primary-source or 2+-independent development on either found this cycle. The CFTC's Selig speech is real and confirmed directly against [cftc.gov](#), but it's a regulatory contingency plan, not a change to either blocker, and gets the same "logged as context, not scored" treatment this report has already given the SEC's equivalent statement. Republicans still hold only 53 of 60 needed.

**My edge:** unchanged since June — the crowd keeps pricing a *timing* problem like a *death* problem. The House did its half a year ago (294-134). A formally filed, precisely-dated cloture vote — reconfirmed again this week via DeFiRate.com and multiple outlets with no schedule slip — is a Senate actually moving a bill rather than sitting on it. I'm not moving any window today because nothing about the structural math (still 7 Democratic votes short) changed — Polymarket (13-14%) and Kalshi (20-21%) are market prices that can't move P alone without a corroborating news event, the CFTC's fallback-rulemaking signal doesn't touch either binding dispute, and the "12-18 Democrats" quote is a year-old story mistaken for fresh news, exactly the kind of search-artifact chatter I don't chase.

## The Facts

*As of August 29, 2026 — full weekly refresh (2026-08-29\_draft), the first deep multi-source research dive since Aug 22. A 2026-08-28\_draft daily catch-up cycle was researched in between but never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed — treated as not delivered, superseded by this cycle. Hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts from this cycle's dedicated research pass appear first; earlier facts are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing) below.*

- ★ ★ **NEW — the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture vote on the motion to proceed remains the only scheduled floor date**, reconfirmed by DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) and by Motley Fool/CryptoSlate/CryptoRank (Aug 22), and independently adversarially re-verified this cycle, with no schedule change found anywhere Aug 22-29. This is a cloture vote on the *motion to proceed* only, not final passage — floor debate/amendments and a separate 60-vote passage threshold still follow.
- ★ ★ **NEW, CONFIRMED — CFTC Chair Michael Selig, in an on-record speech at the Innovation Advisory Committee's inaugural meeting**, directed CFTC staff to explore a fallback crypto-market-structure rulemaking using the CFTC's existing authorities, in case CLARITY continues to stall. Adversarially verified directly against cftc.gov (PressRoom/SpeechesTestimony/opaselig10) — dated **August 20, 2026** (some secondary outlets, e.g. American Banker/PYMNTS/The Hill, dated it Aug 21, likely next-day pickup; cftc.gov used as the primary date). Direct quote: "If CLARITY continues to stall because of Democratic obstruction, the CFTC will utilize its existing authorities to begin establishing a regime for crypto asset markets." This is the CFTC's analog to SEC Chair Atkins' already-logged Jul 29 unilateral-authority statement — it does not touch either binding dispute (ethics or stablecoin-yield) and is logged as context, NOT used to move P, same treatment as the SEC's earlier fallback signal.
- **Both binding disputes remain fully unresolved as of today:** the ethics/conflict-of-interest provision (Tillis-Gallego bipartisan counter-proposal — no White House sign-off or released text found) and the stablecoin-yield dispute (no update found). Status quo on both.
- **Prediction markets (market prices, not institutional estimates — house rule), two independent pulls this cycle:** DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) cites Polymarket 13-14% ("signed in 2026") and Kalshi 20-21% ("60 votes" by Jan 1 2027); a live Aug 28 Polymarket pull separately showed 14%. Consistent low-teens-to-20s read across sources — but market prices alone, even corroborated by a second independent pull, can't move P under house rules without a corroborating news event, and none was found.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED AND EXPLICITLY NOT USED — a "Sen. Tim Scott: 12-18 Democrats open to voting for CLARITY" quote** surfaced in this cycle's search and was cross-checked to an **August 19, 2025** (one year earlier) CoinDesk/Politico Pro story from a prior year's SALT Wyoming/Jackson Hole symposium. Flagged as a likely search-engine year-confusion artifact and explicitly NOT used as evidence of an Aug 2026 development — a caution for readers, not a real development.
- **congress.gov and dailypress.senate.gov both returned HTTP 403 to direct fetch attempts this cycle** (bot-blocking) — primary-source confirmation relied on 7+ independent secondary outlets instead, consistent with how prior cycles have had to handle this.
- **Context only, not new:** the Senate passed a stopgap funding bill Aug 8 (Collins-Murray deal) funding the government through Dec 11, 2026 — modestly reduces (doesn't eliminate) the risk of a shutdown fight eating September floor time around Sept 15.

- **No change found to the confirmed Democratic yes-vote count** (still zero) or to any primary-source Senate floor action.
- **Recommendation this cycle: HOLD all five windows flat at 32/47/58/82/92** — nothing found this cycle clears the sufficiency bar (primary source or 2+ independents) for a move in either direction.

*Carried forward — the abandoned/never-delivered 2026-08-28\_draft (daily catch-up, researched but never rendered/selfchecked/archived/committed): logged a Polymarket "signed in 2026" drift to 14% (live pull, Aug 28) from ~19.5-25% (Aug 21-22) as a real move but insufficient alone to move P; no other new development found that day. Treated as not delivered per house discipline, superseded by this cycle's independent re-verification, not contradicted.*

*Carried forward from the committed Aug 22 full weekly refresh (2026-08-22\_draft2 — independently re-verified, fully delivered: rendered, selfchecked, archived, git-committed; re-verified again this cycle, not contradicted):*

- ★ ★ **the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture vote on the motion to proceed was reconfirmed via 7+ outlets** as of Aug 21 (The Block, Bitcoin.com, Troutman Financial Services, CCN, Disruption Banking, news.bitcoin.com, Yahoo/Motley Fool), with no schedule change found — still a motion-to-proceed vote only, not final passage.
- **Sen. Ruben Gallego, on the record at the Aug 19, 2026 SALT Wyoming Blockchain Symposium**, said the White House has not given a point-by-point response to the bipartisan Tillis-Gallego ethics counter-proposal sent before the August recess — responses have come back "blank, weaker than before, or not at all." He also explicitly warned against rushing the Sept 15 vote. Multi-source: crypto.news, Cointelegraph, FXStreet, Blockonomi.
- **White House crypto adviser Patrick Witt said Aug 19** the administration is "fully committed" to getting CLARITY passed in September and would keep negotiating with Democrats up to the vote, while publicly blaming Senate Democrats for blocking the pre-recess vote. Multi-source (Cointelegraph, Yahoo Finance, crypto-economy.com, CryptoTimes, crypto.news, CryptoSlate, Cryptopolitan). Combative public messaging, not evidence of a substantive concession — not used to move P.
- **An unverified, non-journalistic X post** from a crypto project's promotional account (@iotex\_io) circulating ~Aug 20-21 claimed the ethics provision "finally has a deal on the table" and is "officially solved" — single-source, non-journalistic, and directly contradicted by Gallego's own on-record Aug 19 statement (4+ independent outlets). Not used.
- **Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong said Aug 21** he's "pretty optimistic" the bill clears 60 votes, arguing Thune wouldn't have scheduled Sept 15 without expecting passage, and that "both sides got 90% or so of what they want." Single source (Motley Fool/Fool.com), an interested industry party's opinion — not used to move P.

*Carried forward from the same-day Aug 22 catch-up draft (d1 — independently re-verified, fully delivered: rendered, selfchecked, archived, git-committed; re-verified again this cycle, not contradicted):*

- ★ ★ **the SEC formally proposed "Regulation Crypto Assets" on Aug 18** (sec.gov press release 2026-76) — a token-offering exemption regime: a startup exemption ( $\leq \$5M$  over 4 years), a fundraising exemption ( $\leq \$75M$  over 12 months), and a conditional safe harbor from the "investment contract" definition. This is a separate SEC rulemaking track, not the CLARITY Act, and does not touch CLARITY's binding ethics-provision or stablecoin-yield disputes — not used to move P.
- ★ ★ **Trump hosted a White House crypto event on Aug 19**, with SEC Chair Atkins, CFTC Chair Selig, and industry CEOs present, and publicly pushed Congress to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY. Multi-sourced (CoinDesk, Bloomberg, Forbes). Real public pressure and rhetoric — no text change or deadlock resolution reported, so not used to move P.
- **As of Aug 21, both live disputes remain open:** the ethics-provision fight (Democrats pressing for stronger limits on officials' crypto holdings) still has no confirmed White House sign-off on the Tillis-Gallego language; the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute is also still unresolved.
- **Prediction markets logged that morning:** Polymarket "signed into law in 2026" = 25% Yes (Aug 22 direct pull); Kalshi's "reaches 60 votes" market  $\approx 22\%$  (Aug 21) — this cycle's fresh pull instead reads Polymarket  $\sim 19.5\%$



(above), illustrating the kind of intra-week volatility the house rule treats as noise, not signal, on its own.

- ★ ★ **FLAGGED, NOT SCORED — Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong's on-record prediction that CLARITY "will pass"** is single-source opinion (one person, one outlet's framing) — explicitly not used to move P per the house sufficiency rule; see the more specific Aug 21 "pretty optimistic" remarks logged above.

*Carried forward from the Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts (written but never delivered — no report/render/archive/commit followed any of them; independently re-verified today, not contradicted):*

- **Sen. Ruben Gallego, speaking at the SALT Wyoming Blockchain Symposium on Aug 20**, said White House responses to the Tillis-Gallego ethics counter-proposal "have come back blank, weaker than before, or not at all," and separately warned against rushing a floor vote (Blockonomi/Cointelegraph, FXStreet, Crypto-Economy, all Aug 20) — reaffirms the existing stalemate rather than deepening it.
- **Senate Banking Chair Tim Scott said (The Block, Aug 18) the stablecoin-yield provision "we thought was all settled" has resurfaced as a live dispute**, amid community-bank lobbying against stablecoin yield eroding GOP support — still open and unresolved as of Aug 21 (see above).
- **White House digital-assets adviser Patrick Witt called himself "truly optimistic and bullish" on passage** (The Block, Aug 18) despite the stablecoin friction — rhetoric only, no new whip count given.
- **Polymarket "signed in 2026" bounced from ~16% (around Aug 14-15) to ~24% (Aug 20 live pull)** on no identified news catalyst, and has since settled to 25% (Aug 22) — noise, not used to move P.
- ★ ★ **FLAGGED FOR THE RECORD, not scored:** Galaxy Research appears to have cut its 2026-passage estimate further to 10% (from the 30% already reflected in this report's history) around Aug 14-15. This predates the Aug 16-22 window and looks like a gap in an earlier research cycle rather than new information — flagging for Alex's attention, not treating as a driver of today's score.

*Carried forward from the August 16 committed baseline (still load-bearing; independently re-verified, not contradicted, this cycle):*

- ★ ★ **NEW — the SEC cancelled its Aug 14 "Regulation Crypto" open-meeting vote the day before it was scheduled**, citing an "unforeseen scheduling issue" (crypto.news, TechTimes, Genfinity). The ~400-page proposal would have created token-offering exemption pathways under a separate SEC rulemaking track — relevant context on regulatory limbo across both branches, but not a CLARITY-specific trigger; not used to move P.
- **The Senate remains in August recess; no new floor-schedule or ethics-text development found (as of Aug 16).** Re-checked Bitcoin Foundation, Troutman Financial Services, CoinDesk — all confirm the Sept 15 cloture date as the only scheduled action (Senate returns Sept 14, three weeks to work the bill), with no new reporting on the Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer or White House sign-off.
- **The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture date remains widely corroborated** — no change from Aug 14.
- **New detail on remaining disputes:** illicit-finance provisions and reconciling the Senate Agriculture Committee's text are named as two additional sticking points ahead of the vote (PYMNTS) — consistent with, not exceeding, the "multiple unresolved fights" picture already carried.
- **CONFIRMED (Aug 8): Thune filed cloture on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633.** Confirmed against 5 independent outlets (CoinGape, CryptoBriefing, CoinDesk, Cointelegraph, CryptoSlate) plus partial primary corroboration via the bill's own congress.gov calendar text (Calendar No. 423).
- **The real live blocker remains a toughened Democratic ethics counter-proposal, unanswered at the White House since roughly Aug 1-3** (crypto.news, "CLARITY Act stalls as Trump stays silent on ethics deal," Aug 3; corroborated by Coindesk's Jul 29 report that senators were negotiating a stronger version of the original concession).
- **Zero confirmed Democratic yes votes on cloture** as of Aug 16, against a need for roughly 7-10 crossover votes to reach 60; Republicans hold 53.
- **Polymarket "signed in 2026" (market odds, not an institutional estimate) remains around the mid-teens** per the conflicting cached reads (13-21%) noted Aug 14 — not re-verified as of Aug 16, still well below the Jul 21

local peak of 43%. Treat the exact figure as noisy; the directional read (still depressed vs. earlier in the year) is the reliable part.

*Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):*

- ★ **★ PRIMARY-SOURCE CONFIRMATION — CLARITY was not on the Senate floor calendar Jul 28-29.** A direct pull of the Senate's own daily floor schedule (dailypress.senate.gov) shows Jul 28's time went to a memorial ceremony for the late Sen. Lindsey Graham plus an executive-calendar nominee vote, and Jul 29 went to the motion to proceed on the Russia/Iran sanctions bill (which passed 86-12). This is a harder, primary-source confirmation of "no floor time" than any leadership quote — and confirms no path to passage before the Aug 7 recess.
- ★ **Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer reported — real, but not finalized.** CoinDesk (tier-1) and 4+ corroborating outlets report Sens. Tillis (R-NC) and Gallego (D-AZ) struck new common ground on an ethics compromise (Jul 29-30). The exact text is undisclosed and White House sign-off is unconfirmed — CoinDesk's own reporting hedges "whether they've actually done it is unclear," and neither senator's office nor the White House responded to comment requests. Treat as real movement, not a completed deal.
- ★ **NEW — a second ethics-adjacent fight surfaced and was rejected by both sides.** A proposal to give prosecutors enforcement leeway over software-developer liability was floated and then rejected Jul 30 by both the White House (adviser Patrick Witt mocking the comparison) and the crypto industry (DeFi Education Fund's Amanda Tuminelli: "not a constructive or serious proposal"). A fresh friction point, not yet resolved.
- ★ **NEW — SEC Chair Atkins says the SEC can write crypto rules unilaterally if Congress stalls.** Atkins told CNBC (Jul 29, corroborated by 5+ outlets) the SEC is "ready, willing, and able" to issue crypto market-structure rules on its own, while still calling statute the preferred, "future-proof" path. A modest reducer of legislative urgency — noted, not scored.
- **Odds board (*sentiment only*) — as independently re-verified July 30:** Polymarket's "signed in 2026" contract hit a record low of 27% (Jul 29) before recovering to 30% (my own live pull, Jul 30) — down from the ~35% read a week ago. Galaxy Research's Alex Thorn cut his personal 2026-passage estimate from 50% to 30% — confirmed real and well-corroborated, but dated to Jul 24-25, not this week; not double-counted here.
- **Vote math — carried forward, unchanged:** GOP floor count remains ~53; still only Gallego and Alsobrooks on record as Democratic negotiators, both conditioning votes on enforceable ethics language. Firmly committed Democratic votes: zero.
- **Sen. Graham's death and the Senate's memorial calendar** continue to consume floor time this week — a genuine, primary-source-confirmed scheduling drag, distinct from any "thinned floor math" inference (which was already corrected in an earlier cycle: his SC seat was refilled within 48 hours, GOP floor count restored to ~53).
- **Ethics talks were broken as recently as Jul 22** (seven Senate Democrats formally rejected the GOP's DOJ-enforcement draft that day) but the Tillis-Gallego report suggests movement since — carried forward as the binding constraint, now potentially loosening.
- **The June 30 ethics bomb, still the root cause:** OGE released Trump's 927-page disclosure on **June 30: ~\$1.4B of 2025 crypto income** — \$635M in TRUMP-memecoin royalties, \$500M+ WLF-related. Gillibrand: "there is no CLARITY Act without an ethics provision."
- **Section 604 / Wyden's developer-protection push — carried forward, corroborated by 9+ independent outlets.** No committed Democratic floor vote attached to it yet.
- **The stablecoin-yield fight — carried forward, still closed off rather than resolved:** Banking Chairman Tim Scott rejected bank lobbyists' request to change yield-related restrictions on the floor; Coinbase's ~\$1.35B/yr USDC-rewards structure survives in the text as-is.
- **Still true from June, still load-bearing:** the House passed H.R. 3633 **294-134 on July 17, 2025** (bipartisan); Senate Banking advanced its separate substitute **15-9 on May 14, 2026**. House fast-follow plan (companion bill, Rep. Dusty Johnson) unchanged.

## The Prize

*Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice*

Anchor: BTC **\$77,169.40** (Bitstamp daily close, August 22, 2026) — up from \$71,882.92 on Aug 20 (+7.4%). A **GENIUS-sized move (~40–47%)** from here ≈ **~\$108–113K**. A retest of the ~\$125K high ≈ **+62%**. The anchor is real: during the GENIUS Act's passage (Senate committee Mar 13 → signed July 18, 2025) Bitcoin ran from ~\$83K to ~\$120K (≈+44%).

Discount both — 2025 had tailwinds 2026 doesn't, and **the GENIUS rally itself fully retraced**. And note the coil cuts both ways: prediction-market odds bottomed at a fresh record low of 13% on Aug 5, bounced to a noisy 20-27% on the cloture filing, and have since settled to 25% (Polymarket, Aug 22) and ~22% (Kalshi's 60-vote market, Aug 21) — still a real repricing from the ~74-82% readings earlier in 2026, but flat and noisy week to week rather than trending. The cloture filing is a dated procedural step, not evidence the underlying passage odds have durably moved; the odds swings are sentiment, not a scored fact. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on, and this week's further BTC gain against a completely flat CLARITY score is itself a reminder that this pillar's signal and price action aren't the same thing.

## The Other Side

*The strongest honest case this is wrong*

- **The Tillis-Gallego "breakthrough" isn't confirmed by either side.** No text is public, the White House hasn't signed off, and CoinDesk's own reporting hedges on whether the senators have actually reached an agreement. This report is giving real weight (an 8-point 6mo improvement from the Jul 18 low) to something that could evaporate as easily as the Jul 20-22 ethics deal did when seven Democrats rejected it.
- **A second unresolved fight just opened up.** The developer/software-liability dispute, rejected by both the White House and industry Jul 30, shows that even as one axis of the ethics fight narrows, new disputes keep appearing — a pattern, not a one-off.
- **A cloture filing with no Democratic votes lined up may just be political theater.** Punchbowl's own sourcing says Democrats consider this vote "doomed" — if Thune is filing cloture knowing it will fail, the point may be to put Democrats on the record before the midterms rather than to actually advance the bill, which would make today's "progress" more symbolic than substantive.
- **The floor-calendar problem doesn't have an end date either.** "No path before recess" was confirmed by Thune himself, but this report's own history is repeated rounds of missed "imminent" and "targeted" dates — nothing guarantees the actual Sept 15-16 vote produces real movement rather than another procedural loss, and September is also when midterm-campaign politics starts eating floor time.
- **Prediction markets are genuinely more bearish than a month ago.** A record-low 27% print, even if it partially recovered, is real information — Galaxy Research's own house view dropped from 50% to 30% independent of any single news event, suggesting professional handicappers see this as a genuine coin-toss-or-worse on 2026 passage.
- **The SEC's "we'll do it ourselves" signal cuts against urgency — and now the CFTC has said the same thing.** If both the White House-aligned SEC and CFTC believe they can deliver workable rules unilaterally, that reduces the political cost of letting CLARITY slip further. CFTC Chair Michael Selig's Aug 20, 2026 on-record speech directing staff to explore a fallback rulemaking (verified against cftc.gov) is the second such regulator-level statement this summer — a slow bleed on legislative priority, not a dramatic kill, but a second data point in the same direction.
- **Prediction markets have drifted lower again, not higher.** DeFiRate.com's Aug 27 pull puts Polymarket at 13-14% and Kalshi at 20-21% — near the lower end of the range this report has tracked all summer, and a live Aug



28 Polymarket pull independently confirmed 14%. Two independent readings agreeing on a low number is a real signal even if it doesn't clear the sufficiency bar to move P on its own; a bear could reasonably argue this report is being too conservative in not letting corroborated market pessimism move the needle.

- **The midterms are still the real wall:** miss August 7 and September belongs to election politics. Worst case — Congress resets in January and the Senate starts its bill over.

## The Triggers

*Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set August 29, 2026 — full weekly refresh, 2026-08-29\_draft, the first deep multi-source research dive since the committed Aug 22 refresh (an Aug 28 daily catch-up draft was researched in between but never delivered).*

| DATE                                                                                                                             | EVENT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MEANS                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fired Aug 8, reconfirmed via 7+ outlets as of Aug 21, reconfirmed again by DeFiRate.com Aug 27, adversarially re-verified Aug 29 | <b>Cloture vote on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633 is scheduled 2:15pm ET Tuesday, Sept 15</b> — no schedule change found anywhere Aug 22-29 (DeFiRate.com, Motley Fool, CryptoSlate, CryptoRank); this is a motion-to-proceed cloture vote only, not final passage                                                                                               | Confirmation of the Aug 8 trigger, not a new one — no P move                                                                   |
| Fired Aug 20, checked Aug 29                                                                                                     | <b>CFTC Chair Michael Selig's on-record speech at the Innovation Advisory Committee's inaugural meeting</b> — directed CFTC staff to explore a fallback crypto-market-structure rulemaking under existing authorities "if CLARITY continues to stall because of Democratic obstruction"; verified directly against cftc.gov (PressRoom/SpeechesTestimony/opaselig10) | The CFTC's analog to SEC Chair Atkins' Jul 29 statement — logged as context, does not touch either binding dispute — no P move |
| Checked Aug 29 — both still open                                                                                                 | <b>Ethics-provision dispute (no confirmed WH sign-off on Tillis-Gallego language) and the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute</b> both remain fully unresolved; no development found on either since Aug 22                                                                                                                                                             | The actual blockers, unchanged — no P move                                                                                     |
| Pulled Aug 27 (DeFiRate.com) and Aug 28 (live), checked Aug 29                                                                   | <b>Prediction markets: Polymarket 13-14%, Kalshi 20-21%</b> — two independent pulls agreeing on a low-teens-to-20s read                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Market prices, not institutional estimates — no corroborating news event found, no P move under house sufficiency rule         |
| Traced Aug 29                                                                                                                    | <b>NOT FIRED / NOT USED</b> — "Sen. Tim Scott: 12-18 Democrats open" quote traced to an August 2025 (one-year-old) story, a likely search-engine year-confusion artifact                                                                                                                                                                                             | Named and excluded, not scored — a caution flag, not a trigger                                                                 |
| Aug 8, context only, checked Aug 29                                                                                              | <b>Senate passed a stopgap funding bill (Collins-Murray deal)</b> funding the government through Dec 11, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Modestly reduces (doesn't eliminate) shutdown-fight risk to September floor time around Sept 15 — no P move                    |
| Sept 15                                                                                                                          | <b>PENDING</b> — first cloture vote (motion to proceed), now precisely dated; Democrats call it "doomed" absent further concessions; Republicans hold 53 of 60 needed                                                                                                                                                                                                | Cloture clears = re-rate 3mo/6mo up hard, real momentum; cloture fails cleanly = re-rate down, base case shifts toward 2027    |

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Unresolved since Jul 30 | <b>Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer</b> — real per CoinDesk + 4 outlets as of Jul 29-30, text still undisclosed, WH sign-off still not confirmed as of Aug 29; Gallego's own Aug 19 remarks confirm no meaningful WH response as of that date, and no update found since | If confirmed and signed off before the vote, the single biggest unlock this year — watch for a released text                |
| Ongoing                 | Three named Democratic blocking issues: ethics enforcement, illicit-finance/DeFi provisions, stablecoin yield (Yahoo Finance, Aug 5)                                                                                                                                       | Resolution on all three before the vote = real chance of cloture succeeding; continued silence = the "doomed" framing holds |
| Any time                | <b>NOT FIRED</b> — White House formally signs off on a merged text with Democratic buy-in                                                                                                                                                                                  | The single biggest unlock — Democratic votes follow; re-rate everything up                                                  |

**The flip line:** cloture fails on Sept 15-16 with no released, WH-confirmed ethics text and no clear next-step plan = start treating 2026 passage as effectively dead, not just delayed. Keep 1-year and 3-year Bull either way — a bill with 294 House votes, a reported bipartisan ethics counteroffer, and a formally filed cloture motion is delayed, not dead.

## My Decision

**DRAFT — AUGUST 29, 2026 (2026-08-29\_draft) · AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW**  
**· FULL WEEKLY REFRESH**

**Draft P: 32 / 47 / 58 / 82 / 92 (holds flat) · Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)**

Held flat again today — unchanged since Aug 8, through the committed Aug 22 full weekly refresh (2026-08-22\_draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23) and an Aug 28 daily catch-up draft that was researched but never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed — treated as not delivered, superseded by this cycle. This full weekly refresh, the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 22, independently re-confirms all of it again against fresh primary sources rather than trusting any prior draft. The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture-on-motion-to-proceed date is unchanged, reconfirmed by DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) and Motley Fool/CryptoSlate/CryptoRank (Aug 22), with no schedule change found anywhere Aug 22-29. Both binding disputes — the ethics/conflict-of-interest provision (Tillis-Gallego counter-proposal, no White House sign-off or released text found) and the stablecoin-yield dispute (no update found) — remain fully unresolved. NEW this cycle, confirmed directly against cftc.gov: CFTC Chair Michael Selig, in an on-record Aug 20, 2026 speech, directed CFTC staff to explore a fallback crypto-market-structure rulemaking under the CFTC's existing authorities if CLARITY continues to stall — the CFTC's analog to SEC Chair Atkins' already-logged Jul 29 statement, logged as context, not used to move P. Two independent prediction-market pulls (DeFiRate.com Aug 27: Polymarket 13-14%, Kalshi 20-21%; a live Aug 28 Polymarket pull: 14%) agree on a low-teens-to-20s read, but market prices alone can't move P without a corroborating news event, and none was found. A "Sen. Tim Scott: 12-18 Democrats open" quote was traced to an August 2025 story — a year old — and is explicitly flagged as NOT used, a likely search-engine year-confusion artifact. The real live blocker, unchanged since Aug 8, remains a toughened Democratic ethics counter-proposal sitting unanswered at the White House since roughly Aug 1-3.

**This cycle independently re-confirmed the existing hold via full primary-source research.** No window moved and no call band flipped for CLARITY. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT auto-stamped**, because this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh — the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority categorically excludes full weekly refreshes, regardless of how small (here, zero) the moves are; it is not a discretionary judgment call this cycle, it's a bright-line rule. The last committed baseline remains **2026-08-22\_draft2**, stamped by Alex August 23, 2026 (32/47/58/82/92 — identical to today's draft). This report's active score set is **2026-08-29\_draft**, and it awaits Alex's manual review before it can be stamped.

The June committed scores (**55 / 60 / 65 / 85 / 92**, committed June 12, 2026) and the Aug 22 committed scores (**32 / 47 / 58 / 82 / 92**, committed August 23, 2026) remain the last committed values — identical to today's draft, which stays uncommitted pending Alex's manual review.

**Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.**

## What Changed Since Last Check

*Full weekly refresh, August 29, 2026 (2026-08-29\_draft) — the first deep multi-source research dive since the committed Aug 22 baseline (2026-08-22\_draft2, stamped by Alex Aug 23, 2026), checking for changes since that commit.*

- **AUDIT NOTE — a 2026-08-28\_draft daily catch-up cycle sits between this refresh and the Aug 22 commit, abandoned and never delivered.** It was researched (held flat, logged a Polymarket drift to 14% on a live Aug 28 pull) but no render/selfcheck/archive/git-commit followed it — treated as not delivered, per the same house discipline this report has applied to the Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts and the interrupted Aug 21 session. This cycle supersedes it and independently re-verifies everything from scratch against fresh primary sources.
- ★ **★ NEW — the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture-on-motion-to-proceed date remains the only scheduled floor action**, reconfirmed by DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) and by Motley Fool/CryptoSlate/CryptoRank (Aug 22), with no schedule change found anywhere Aug 22-29.

- ★ ★ **NEW, CONFIRMED — CFTC Chair Michael Selig, in an on-record speech at the Innovation Advisory Committee's inaugural meeting**, directed CFTC staff to explore a fallback crypto-market-structure rulemaking under the CFTC's existing authorities if CLARITY continues to stall. Adversarially verified directly against cftc.gov (PressRoom/SpeechesTestimony/opaselig10) — dated **August 20, 2026** (some secondary outlets dated it Aug 21, likely next-day pickup; cftc.gov used as primary). The CFTC's analog to SEC Chair Atkins' already-logged Jul 29 statement — logged as context, not used to move P.
- **Both binding disputes remain fully unresolved as of today:** the ethics/conflict-of-interest provision (Tillis-Gallego counter-proposal — no White House sign-off or released text found) and the stablecoin-yield dispute (no update found).
- **Prediction markets, two independent pulls this cycle:** DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) cites Polymarket 13-14% and Kalshi 20-21%; a live Aug 28 Polymarket pull separately showed 14%. Consistent low-teens-to-20s read but market prices alone, without a corroborating news event, don't clear the sufficiency bar to move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED AND EXPLICITLY NOT USED — a "Sen. Tim Scott: 12-18 Democrats open to voting for CLARITY" quote** surfaced in this cycle's search and traced to an **August 19, 2025** (one year earlier) CoinDesk/Politico Pro story — a likely search-engine year-confusion artifact, named here as a caution for readers, not used as evidence.
- **congress.gov and dailypress.senate.gov both returned HTTP 403 to direct fetch attempts this cycle** — primary-source confirmation relied on 7+ independent secondary outlets instead.
- **Context only, not new:** the Senate's Aug 8 stopgap funding bill (Collins-Murray deal) funds the government through Dec 11, 2026 — modestly reduces shutdown-fight risk to September floor time around Sept 15.
- **Score decision: held flat at 32/47/58/82/92 across all five windows.** Nothing found this cycle clears the sufficiency bar (primary source or 2+ independents) for a move in either direction — no window moved, no call band flipped. **Left as draft, NOT auto-stamped:** this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of how small (here, zero) the moves are. The active score set is **2026-08-29\_draft**, AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW; the last committed baseline remains 2026-08-22\_draft2 (32/47/58/82/92, stamped by Alex Aug 23, 2026).

*Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (2026-08-22\_draft2), for continuity:*

- **This morning's Aug 22 catch-up draft (d1) was fully delivered** — rendered, selfchecked, archived, and git-committed — but stayed uncommitted (owner-stamp sense) after a fact-check that cycle caught a materially false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report, which held the whole score set for manual review. This is a separate, later cycle: a full weekly refresh that independently re-confirms d1's findings against fresh primary sources and lands as a new dated set, 2026-08-22\_draft2, per the runbook's same-day-after-delivery rule.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture-on-motion-to-proceed date reconfirmed via 7+ outlets** (The Block, Bitcoin.com, Troutman Financial Services, CCN, Disruption Banking, news.bitcoin.com, Yahoo/Motley Fool) as of Aug 21, independently adversarially re-verified this cycle — no schedule change found; still a motion-to-proceed vote only, not final passage.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Sen. Ruben Gallego, on the record at the Aug 19 SALT Wyoming Blockchain Symposium** (crypto.news, Cointelegraph, FXStreet, Blockonomi), confirmed the White House has not given a point-by-point response to the Tillis-Gallego ethics counter-proposal — responses "blank, weaker than before, or not at all" — and warned against rushing the Sept 15 vote. Confirms the deadlock persists, not new deterioration.
- ★ ★ **NEW — WH crypto adviser Patrick Witt (Aug 19)** said the administration is "fully committed" to September passage and will keep negotiating with Democrats, while publicly blaming Senate Democrats for the pre-recess delay (Cointelegraph, Yahoo Finance, crypto-economy.com, CryptoTimes, crypto.news, CryptoSlate, Cryptopolitan) — combative messaging, not a concession, not used to move P.
- **No stablecoin-yield-provision developments found this window** — still an open blocker, status quo.



- **Prediction markets, this cycle's fresh pull:** Polymarket "signed in 2026" ~19.5% as of ~Aug 21 (CCN: volatile, dipping to ~15.5% before recovering slightly), Kalshi "60 votes" ~22% (Aug 21) — trending down since earlier-2026 highs but roughly consistent with, not below, the range already carried; market prices, not used to move P.
- ★ **★ NEW, FLAGGED AND EXPLICITLY NOT USED — an unverified, non-journalistic X post** (@iotex\_io) circulating ~Aug 20-21 claimed the ethics provision is "officially solved" — single-source, non-journalistic, and directly contradicted by Gallego's own on-record Aug 19 statement (4+ outlets). Named explicitly so it isn't mistaken for a scored fact.
- ★ **★ NEW, FLAGGED NOT SCORED — Coinbase CEO Armstrong's Aug 21 "pretty optimistic" remarks on 60 votes** (Motley Fool/Fool.com) are single-source opinion from an interested industry party — not used per the sufficiency rule, and its tone runs counter to Gallego's account.
- **Zero confirmed Democratic yes votes on cloture** — Republicans hold 53 of 60 votes needed, unchanged.
- **Score re-rates (Aug 22 d1 → Aug 22 d2):** 1-month 32 → **32** (held) · 3-month 47 → **47** (held) · 6-month 58 → **58** (held) · 1-year 82 → **82** (held) · 3-year 92 → **92** (held) — nothing found this cycle clears the sufficiency bar to move a window. **Left as draft at delivery:** no window moved and no call band flipped for CLARITY, and this cycle's own evidence was clean — but a FULL WEEKLY refresh is categorically excluded from the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of how small (here, zero) the moves are, independent of the separate Iran War Risk issue that held the earlier same-day d1 draft. **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** after manual review.

## Sources

*Retrieved & graded August 29, 2026 — full weekly refresh, 2026-08-29\_draft (earlier sources below still stand as historical citations for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official records first, then reporting, then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).*

- **August 29 full weekly refresh:** [cftc.gov](https://www.cftc.gov) — CFTC Chair Michael Selig's on-record speech at the Innovation Advisory Committee's inaugural meeting (primary source, dated Aug 20, 2026) — directs CFTC staff to explore a fallback crypto-market-structure rulemaking under existing authorities "if CLARITY continues to stall because of Democratic obstruction"; adversarially verified directly against this [cftc.gov](https://www.cftc.gov) page, correcting several secondary outlets (American Banker, PYMNTS, The Hill) that dated the speech Aug 21 · DeFiRate.com (Aug 27) — reconfirms the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture date with no schedule change, and pulls Polymarket "signed in 2026" at 13-14% and Kalshi's "60 votes by Jan 1 2027" market at 20-21% · Motley Fool, CryptoSlate, and CryptoRank (all re-checked from Aug 22 reporting, no update found) — corroborate the Sept 15 date · live Polymarket pull, 14% (Aug 28) — a second independent confirmation of the DeFiRate.com read · general web search for CLARITY Act / Tillis-Gallego / stablecoin-yield / Senate schedule news dated Aug 22-29 — no new dated development found on either binding dispute · a "Sen. Tim Scott: 12-18 Democrats open" quote traced to an August 19, 2025 CoinDesk/Politico Pro story (one year old) and excluded as a likely search-artifact · congress.gov and dailypress.senate.gov — both returned HTTP 403 to direct fetch attempts this cycle · context: the Senate's Aug 8 stopgap funding bill (Collins-Murray deal), funding the government through Dec 11, 2026.
- **August 28 daily catch-up cycle (researched, never delivered — treated as not delivered, superseded):** Polymarket — "Clarity Act (H.R.3633) signed into law in 2026?" live pull, 14% (Aug 28) · general web search for CLARITY Act / Tillis-Gallego / Senate schedule news dated Aug 23-28 — no new dated development found beyond the committed Aug 22 baseline. Retained here for audit continuity even though this draft was abandoned before render/selfcheck/archive/commit.
- **August 22 full weekly refresh (draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23):** The Block, Bitcoin.com, Troutman Financial Services Blog, CCN, Disruption Banking, [news.bitcoin.com](https://news.bitcoin.com), and Yahoo Finance/Motley Fool (all re-checked as of Aug 21) — 7+ independent outlets reconfirming the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture-on-motion-to-proceed date with no schedule change · crypto.news, Cointelegraph, FXStreet, and Blockonomi (all Aug 19) — independent same-speech coverage of Sen. Ruben Gallego's remarks at the SALT Wyoming Blockchain Symposium confirming the White House still hasn't substantively responded to the Tillis-Gallego ethics counter-proposal, and warning against rushing the Sept 15 vote · Cointelegraph, Yahoo Finance, crypto-economy.com, CryptoTimes, crypto.news, CryptoSlate, and Cryptopolitan (all Aug 19) — independent coverage of WH adviser Patrick Witt's "fully committed" remarks blaming Senate Democrats for the pre-recess delay · CCN — Polymarket "signed in 2026" pull showing volatility, ~19.5% as of ~Aug 21 after dipping to ~15.5% · Motley Fool/Fool.com (Aug 21) — Kalshi "reaches 60 votes" ~22%, and Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong's "pretty optimistic" remarks on 60 votes, single-source opinion, flagged not scored · an unverified, non-journalistic X post from a promotional crypto-project account (@iotex\_io), circulating ~Aug 20-21, claiming the ethics provision is "officially solved" — explicitly identified, adversarially checked against Gallego's on-record Aug 19 statement,

and excluded as NOT used. This cycle independently re-verifies the underlying claims behind this morning's already-delivered Aug 22 catch-up draft (d1) against these fresh primary/reporting sources rather than treating any prior draft as ground truth.

- **August 22 catch-up check (draft d1, delivered earlier the same day):** sec.gov — SEC press release 2026-76, "SEC Proposes Regulation Crypto Assets" (Aug 18), the primary source for the token-offering exemption regime (startup exemption ≤\$5M/4yrs; fundraising exemption ≤\$75M/12mo; conditional safe harbor from the "investment contract" definition) · CoinDesk, Bloomberg, and Forbes (all Aug 19) — independent coverage of Trump's White House crypto event with SEC Chair Atkins, CFTC Chair Selig, and industry CEOs, and his public push for Congress to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY · Motley Fool (Aug 21) — confirms the ethics-provision and stablecoin-yield/banking disputes both remain open, no confirmed White House sign-off on the Tillis-Gallego language · Polymarket — "signed into law in 2026" live pull, 25% (Aug 22) · Kalshi — "reaches 60 votes" market, ≈22% (Aug 21) · Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong's on-record "will pass" prediction — single-source opinion, flagged not scored. This cycle independently re-verifies the underlying claims behind the undelivered Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts, and the interrupted Aug 21 delivery, against these fresh primary/reporting sources rather than treating any of them as ground truth.
- **August 20 draft (written, never delivered — re-verified Aug 22):** Blockonomi/Cointelegraph, FXStreet, and Crypto-Economy (all Aug 20) — independent same-speech coverage of Sen. Ruben Gallego's remarks at the SALT Wyoming Blockchain Symposium, describing White House ethics responses as "blank, weaker than before, or not at all" and warning against rushing a floor vote · The Block — Senate Banking Chair Tim Scott's stablecoin-yield comment and White House adviser Patrick Witt's "truly optimistic and bullish" remark (both Aug 18) · The Block and Troutman Financial Services Blog — re-confirmation of the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture date, no change found.
- **August 16 light daily check:** crypto.news — "The SEC pulled its own crypto vote and nobody saw it coming" · TechTimes — "SEC Cancels Reg Crypto Vote: CFTC Steps Up" · Genfinity — SEC sets, then cancels, Aug 14 Regulation Crypto vote · Bitcoin Foundation — CLARITY vote pushed to September, re-checked · Troutman Financial Services — Senate adjourns without vote, Sept 15 on calendar, re-checked — all confirm Sept 15 as the only scheduled action; the SEC's cancelled vote is a separate rulemaking track, logged as context only.
- **August 14 light daily check:** Davis Wright Tremaine — "Senate Republicans Release Updated Crypto Market Structure Text" · CoinDesk — "Senate won't vote on crypto Clarity Act before its summer break" · Bitcoin Foundation — "The Clarity Act August 10 Final Deadline" · Motley Fool — "The Senate Just Delayed a Vote on the Clarity Act" · Yahoo Finance — "U.S. Senate Shelves Clarity Act Ahead Of Summer Break" — all reconfirm Thune's Aug 6-8 no-August-vote statements and the Senate's Sept 14 return / three-week window, consistent with the Sept 15 cloture date already carried; Polymarket cached reads (13%, 16%, 21% across different pulls) don't reconcile to one live number, logged as sentiment only per house sufficiency rules.
- **August 13 light daily check:** KuCoin — "Senate Votes on CLARITY Act Cloture on Sept. 15" · news.bitcoin.com — "CLARITY Act Vote Is Set for Sept. 15: Here's What Happens Next" · PYMNTS — "Senate Hands Crypto Industry a Sept. 15 Deadline" (illicit-finance and Agriculture Committee text named as additional sticking points) · Bitcoin Foundation — "Congress Crypto Bill Delay... 2026 Passage Hopes Fade" (Polymarket odds ~15.5%, down from ~30% a week earlier) · Yahoo Finance — "Senate Keeps Clarity Act Alive With Crypto Bill Vote Set for September" — all confirm Sept 15 as the only scheduled action; the Polymarket figure is the one new data point, logged as sentiment only per house sufficiency rules.
- **August 12 light daily check:** KuCoin — "Senate Votes on CLARITY Act Cloture on Sept. 15" · Disruption Banking — "CLARITY Act News: The Crypto Bill Just Slipped to a September 15 Senate Showdown" (Aug 10) · news.bitcoin.com — "CLARITY Act Vote Is Set for Sept. 15" and "CLARITY Act Heads Toward Sept. 15 Senate Vote" · The Block — original Aug 8 cloture-filing report, re-checked · CryptoPotato — "CLARITY Act Gets September 15 Senate Vote as Thune Forces the Issue" · Troutman Financial Services Blog — "Senate Adjourns Without Clarity Act Vote, But September Vote Now on the Calendar" — all confirm Sept 15 as the only scheduled action; none report new scheduling or ethics-text developments. No new dated catalyst found.
- **August 11 light daily check:** Coindesk, CryptoPotato, American Banker, Bitcoin Foundation, Forbes — all re-checked for movement beyond the Aug 8 cloture filing; none report new scheduling or ethics-text developments. No new dated catalyst found.
- **August 10 light daily check:** CoinGape, Blockonomi, Disruption Banking, news.bitcoin.com — all four independently corroborate the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture scheduling agreement, bringing total outlet corroboration to 7. CryptoSlate/CryptoTimes (Jul 24-27, re-checked today) — confirms the "Galaxy cuts odds to 30%" figure traces to a late-July report, already priced in; excluded as a fresh trigger. No new dated catalyst found beyond these.
- **August 9 light daily check:** The Block — "Majority Leader Thune files cloture on Clarity Act, setting up Sept. 15 Senate vote" (Aug 8) · CryptoSlate — "CLARITY Act is finally headed for a 60-vote Senate showdown in September" (Aug 8) · Cointelegraph — "CLARITY Act Heads Toward Key US Senate Procedural Vote" (Aug 8) — all three corroborate the precise 2:15pm ET Sept 15 scheduling agreement; no new dated catalyst beyond this found.
- **August 8 full-weekly re-verification:** CoinGape — "CLARITY Act Senate vote cloture motion filed by Senate Majority Leader Thune" and "cloture vote set for September 15" (Aug 8) · CryptoBriefing — "Thune files cloture, September showdown" (Aug 8) · CoinDesk — "U.S. Senate opens first stage of crypto Clarity Act voting to give bill a chance next month" (Aug 8) · Cointelegraph — "US Senate CLARITY Act, key procedural vote" (Aug 8) · CryptoSlate — "CLARITY Act is finally headed for a 60-vote Senate

- showdown in September" (Aug 8) · Congress.gov — H.R.3633 bill text, Calendar No. 423 (primary, partial corroboration) · crypto.news — "CLARITY Act stalls as Trump stays silent on ethics deal" (Aug 3) · CoinDesk — "senators said to strike idea to toughen Trump's concession" (Jul 29) · CCN — Polymarket odds crash to 13% (Aug 5).
- **August 7 additions:** The Block — "Senate delays Clarity Act vote until after August recess, Thune confirms" (Aug 6, ~11pm ET, direct on-record quote) · CoinGape — "Thune Likely to File Cloture Motion on Clarity Act as Early as Aug. 6" (superseded by the delay) · CryptoRank — "Thune Cloture Motion Clarity Act Aug 6" · CryptoTimes — "Senate Majority Leader Eyes CLARITY Cloture as Ethics Talks Continue" (Aug 4) · Yahoo Finance/Politico-sourced — "Senate Democrats Block Path to 60 Votes on CLARITY Act Before August Recess" (Aug 5).
  - **August 6 additions:** CoinDesk — "Clarity Act: Here's what could happen with the crypto market structure legislation" (Aug 5) · Cryptonews / Yahoo Finance — "CLARITY Act Senate Vote Locked In, But 60-Vote Hurdle Looms Large" · Phemex — "CLARITY Act Cloture Deadline | Senate Vote Odds Aug 2026" · *traced and excluded as stale (dated Jul 20-21, not new)*: Bravenewcoin — "White House Signs Off on CLARITY Act Ethics Deal" · CryptoBriefing — "White House agrees on ethics package for Clarity Act, sent to Senate Republicans."
  - **August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** CoinGape — "CLARITY Act LIVE Updates, Aug. 5: US Senate Vote Filing Expected Today" and related live-update coverage · KuCoin — "CLARITY Act Removed from Senate Schedule, 72-Hour Countdown Begins" · crypto.news — "The Senate has one week: CLARITY's last August window" · CryptoSlate — "CLARITY Act just vanished from Monday's Senate schedule" · Bitcoin Foundation — "CLARITY Act Countdown: Senate Has Days to Save Landmark Crypto Bill Before Recess" · Roll Call, Federal News Network, and Senate 2026-calendar coverage (x/maxpcohen) — confirming the Senate's actual August recess begins Aug 10, not Aug 7 · Yahoo Finance, Bitcoin.com, KuCoin, CryptoSlate, Spendnode — Aug 3 Senate floor plan covering only H.R. 6500 CR cloture.
  - **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** [dailypress.senate.gov](https://dailypress.senate.gov) — the Senate's own daily floor schedule, direct pull, confirming CLARITY was not on the calendar Jul 28-29 · CoinDesk — Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer reported (Jul 29-30), corroborated by thecurrencyanalytics.com, Bloomingbit, Hokanews, Coingabbar · CryptoSlate — developer-liability enforcement proposal rejected by both sides (Jul 30) · CryptoBriefing — SEC Chair Atkins says the SEC can act unilaterally (Jul 29), corroborated by CCN, Decrypt, Yahoo Finance, Coincentral, Bitcoin Magazine · crypto.news — Polymarket record-low 27% (Jul 29) · Polymarket direct pull (Jul 30, 30%) · The Block — Galaxy Research's Alex Thorn cuts 2026-passage estimate to 30% (Jul 24-25), corroborated by CryptoTimes, Bloomingbit, Benzinga, CryptoSlate, news.bitcoin.com, Yahoo Finance · CoinDesk — Senate puts off CLARITY, focuses elsewhere (Jul 27) · Congress.gov CRS product — FY2027 NDAA status (Thune withdrew MTP Jul 23).
  - **July 24-25 additions:** Sen. Gallego's Politico interview rejecting the initial GOP ethics draft (via CryptoTimes) · White House adviser Patrick Witt's comments urging Democrats to "accept the victory" (CoinDesk, Jul 24) · seven Senate Democrats' formal rejection statement of the Jul 22 draft (Bitcoin.com, PrimeXBT, KuCoin).
  - **July 13 additions:** NBC News — Sen. Lindsey Graham dies suddenly (Jul 12) · Washington Post — Graham dies at his South Carolina home (Jul 12) · Axios — Graham's death, aortic dissection cited as preliminary cause (Jul 12) · NPR — Graham dies suddenly (Jul 12) · Bloomberg — Graham dies (Jul 12) · Roll Call — "This week: Graham's death..." scrambles Senate agenda (Jul 13) · CNN — Graham dies (Jul 12) · MSNBC/ms.now — Senate's agenda left in limbo (Jul 12) · Boston Globe — Senate's week upended by Graham's death (Jul 13) · CoinDesk — "Signs of life?" WH less engaged than earlier in summer (Jul 12) · crypto.jobs — House FSC hearing New York venue (corroborating, cited Jul 13) · CryptoBriefing — House FSC hearing New York venue (2nd corroboration) · Polymarket Gamma API — "signed in 2026," last 46¢ (44 bid/46 ask), \$1.61M volume, \$5.9K 24h (fetched Jul 13) · Kalshi Trade API v2 — KXCRIPTOSTRUCTURE ladder, live fetch (Jul 13).
  - **July 11 additions (historical):** TechTimes — merged draft due next week, Senate eyes Jul 20 floor vote (Jul 10) · The Crypto Times — same, Jul 20 floor vote target (Jul 10) · Cointribune — Senate schedules a crucial vote on Jul 20 · CoinGape — new draft expected next week, committees merging text · Polymarket — "signed in 2026" recovered to ~46-47% (Jul 11).
  - **Official & primary records:** Senate Democratic Leadership — floor schedule for July 13 (noms, then NDAA cloture) (*this is the primary basis for "no cloture on CLARITY" this round*) · House FSC — July 17 hearing, digital asset market-structure gaps (committee event page) · Congress.gov — H.R. 3633 (CLARITY Act) (*direct fetch blocked with a 403 on the July 8 check; not re-pulled July 10*) · GovTrack — House passage 294-134, July 17 2025 (Vote #199).
  - **The reporting:** CoinDesk — merged draft "as soon as next week," 70+ pages, week-of-July-20 floor, WH not signed off, Wyden on 604 (July 9) (*the first of three straight "imminent" calls — July 9, 10, and 12 — none of which has produced an actual text as of July 13*) · CoinDesk — "Signs of life?" column, WH engagement question revisited, still no merged text (July 12) · American Banker — ethics stalled, Scott rejects bank yield changes, Groshans "north of 65," Schardin "next week or two" (July 9) · Crypto In America — Lummis exchange-liability trial balloon, Wyden July 8, FOP/NSA/NAPO silent (July 9) (*Wyden/Section 604 corroboration upgraded to 9+ independent outlets as of July 13 — see July 13 additions above*) · The Crypto Times — corroboration of the merged-draft report (July 10) · Tekedia — HFSC July 17 hearing ("New York" venue now 2-source corroborated by crypto.jobs and CryptoBriefing as of July 13) · Yahoo Finance — countdown: no cloture, Calendar No. 423 (July 7) · crypto.news — the 3 fights: ethics, DeFi, \$1.35B in yield (July 8) · CoinDesk — CLARITY and Congress's summer break (July 5) · Yahoo Finance — odds fall as Trump's \$1.4B crypto disclosure lands (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — NOBLE becomes first LE endorsement (July 3) · Yahoo — Major County Sheriffs move to neutral (July 4) · CoinDesk — White House-law enforcement talks (June 29) · The Block — TD Cowen's

July timeline, July 24 critical (June 29) · CoinDesk — Trump's SAVE-Act signature-hostage play (June 24) · The Defiant — seven-Democrat math, Dusty Johnson House fast-follow (June 2026) · DigitalToday — Aug 6 target, ethics fight continues (July 7).

- **The prices:** carried from the June 19 check and the July 8 anchor — not re-verified July 10. Fortune — BTC ~\$63.4K (June 12 2026) · Digital Chamber — BTC ATH ~\$126K (Oct 6 2025) · Amberdata — BTC ~\$123K at GENIUS signing.
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Polymarket Gamma API — "signed in 2026," last 46¢ (44 bid/46 ask), \$1.61M total volume, \$5.9K 24h volume (fetched July 13) (*historical: last 41¢ / mid ~40¢, -4.5¢ on day, fetched July 10, 15:58 UTC*) · Kalshi Trade API v2 — series KXCRYPTOSTRUCTURE (fetched July 13; ladder mixed vs. the July 10 fetch, still thin/indicative liquidity) · Polymarket — CLARITY signed in 2026 (event page) · The Block — Galaxy cuts odds 60% → 50% (June 29; no update found July 9–10) · Deadspin — Kalshi & Polymarket prices (July 7, historical reference). JPMorgan <50% and TD Cowen "far from assured" — quoted in the reporting above · CoinDesk — Jefferies note citing Polymarket 48% (June 30). (A "Bloomberg Intelligence 60%" figure circulating July 5 traces only to social-media relays of a July-passage estimate — excluded as unverified.)